



Q. Clearly, this is a milestone moment for both collaborators and Indian fashion, but what is the vision that drives this alliance and why now?

Josh Romm The Met was founded in 1870, in part to serve as a living archive designed to inspire the next generation of artists and makers. Collaborations with designers and brands continue to serve that mission and remind us that celebrating historic art and design is always inspiring and relevant. Collaborating with Sabyasachi is a pinnacle of that goal, as he seeks not only to be inspired by historic motifs in his work but also uplifts time-honoured techniques in the process, creating a bridge between past, present, and future.

Sabyasachi Mukherjee The collaboration takes history out of a display box and allows it to live again through contemporary design. The Metropolitan Museum of Art holds one of the world's great archives of human achievement, spanning more than 5,000 years of art and history. I believe that preservation is more than just protecting the past. For culture to remain relevant, it must be dynamic. It has to be encountered by new generations in new ways.

The timing is equally important. Earlier in my career, I would have approached an opportunity like this simply as a designer. Today, Sabyasachi has the infrastructure, craftsmanship, experience and confidence to approach it as a luxury house.

That changes the conversation. We are no longer looking at history only for inspiration. We have the ability to translate it into objects of extraordinary craftsmanship that can live in the present and eventually become modern heirlooms. For me, this partnership is about cultural memory, but it is also about authorship; demonstrating what Indian craftsmanship can contribute to a global conversation about history, quality, and design.

Q. In the world of luxury retail, how will this partnership recalibrate borders between museum merchandising, licensing and high-end couture collections?

Sabyasachi Mukherjee The object in the museum is the beginning of the design process, not the end product. The ambition was never to take a historic motif, place it on a product and call that collaboration. The Met gave us access to an extraordinary universe of artifacts, histories and ideas—two million objects spanning 5,000 years of art and culture. Our responsibility was to absorb and create something original.

The resulting jewellery possess enough design integrity, material value and craftsmanship to stand independently, even if the customer never sees the object that inspired it. At the same time, knowing the provenance gives the piece a deeper layer of meaning. A museum brings historical authority and extraordinary cultural material. A design house brings interpretation, authorship and contemporary relevance. Neither should diminish the other. If done well, commerce can become another way of keeping culture in circulation.

Josh Romm Visitors and fans of The Met come from all over the world and